Answers and talk notes

Understand Rates and Unit Rates

What your student is learning

Tonight we write each comparison as a fraction, divide both the top and bottom by the bottom number to find the unit rate in fraction form over 1, and compare to find the best buy.

Answers

Ask your student to explain before you look.

1. **B.** $7 over 4 lb. Cost goes on top and pounds on the bottom, so the fraction is $7 over 4 lb.
2. **A.** $3 / 1 lb. 9 ÷ 3 = 3 and 3 ÷ 3 = 1, so the result is $3 / 1 lb.
3. **D.** $2.00. $10.00 ÷ 5 = $2.00 for 1 pound.
4. **C.** Bag B, because $1.60 is less. Bag B, because $1.60 is less per pound than $1.75, is the better buy.
5. **B.** $4. $12 ÷ 3 = $4 for 1 box.

Talk about it

Which option has the lower price for 1 apple, and how do you know?

Home mission

Find two sizes of the same food, like two bags of rice. Read each price and weight. Can your student say each price for 1 pound out loud? Which bag is the better buy?

When they are stuck, ask

- Write the rate as a fraction with cost on TOP and pounds on the BOTTOM. Now divide both parts by the bottom number.
- Write the unit rate in fraction form over 1 (like 1.75 / 1 lb).
- Which unit price is lower?

Try not to say

- The cheaper sticker price is always the better buy.
- Divide the amount of pounds by the dollars.